

UK Fintech: Emerging Growth 2021 Trends

Along with our friends at Deloitte, we've taken a look at the UK's fintech sector to explore emerging growth trends, which may be indicative of where the fintech industry is heading.

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has climbed every year over the last decade (2012-2021).

There was a healthy level of seed-stage investment for fintech in 2021, and examining these deals may be indicative of where the fintech industry is heading.

Here, we explore emerging subsectors such as ethical investing, financial inclusion, sustainability and internationalisation.



Here's a sneak-peek inside

Fintech equity investment

With the number of equity investment deals steadily climbing every year for the last decade, fintech is clearly popular with investors. Between 2012 and 2021, the 4,323 deals raised had a combined value of £18.8b. The investment volume exploded in 2021 in particular, where 20 deals were for £100m or

more. The top deals were Revolut's £578m round, £409m for Monzo and £358m for SaltPay. Other big name fintechs securing these gigawatts included Checkout.com and Starling Bank. The most popular route for taking investment in 2021 was crowdfunding, with Seedrs and Crowdcube topping the

investor ranking. The flourishing sector was also supported by a number of deals involving the government scheme, the Future Fund. This report is the first in a UK fintech series; still to come will be a deep dive into Leeds and Manchester's fintech scene, as well as a 2022 quarterly review.

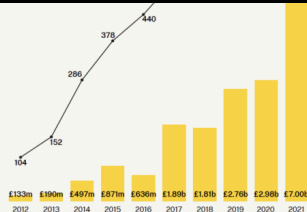
Seed-stage fintech investment

Despite a slight dip in 2020,

Equity investment into seed-stage fintech companies (2012–2021)

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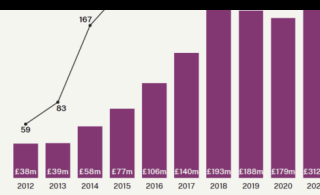


Speedinvest Fintech	6
Octopus Ventures	6
Tiger Global Management	5
SFC Capital	5
Molten Ventures	5
Lakestar	5
Augmentum Fintech	5
Access SIS	5
Accel	5

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subsectors are gaining funding momentum, seed-stage deals are indicative of where the fintech industry may be heading.

In addition to crowdfunding platforms Seedrs and Crowdcube, the source of 14 and nine deals respectively, top investors in seed-stage fintechs in 2021 included London-based European venture capital fund Seedcamp, and early-stage investment firm SFC Capital. Each participated in four separate equity deals. The Future Fund, backed by the British Business Bank, also supported three young fintechs to grow: Elite Capital and Management Services, Emission, and Sweep.



this across the sub-sectors spotlighted in this report.

With fintech being key to the levelling up agenda it is great to see that 174 equity deals were invested in UK fintech firms outside London in 2021.*

Louise Brett,
Head of FinTech and Financial Services Innovation, Deloitte Europe

Deloitte

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More leads, more clients, less churn.

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